Fourth Sunday of Easter (Year A)

Errigal Parish News - 26th April 2026

Weekday Masses: St. Mary's Church: - Monday, Tuesday, and First Friday at 10am.
St. Joseph's Church: - Wednesday at 10am.

St. Mary's Church - (Vigil): Month's Mind Mass: For Tony Deighan on Saturday 6th May at 6pm.
Anniversary Mass - For Anne Moore on Sunday 26th April at 10am.
Anniversary Mass: For Philip Mullan on Sunday 7th May at 10am.
St. Joseph's Church (Vigil) - Anniversary Mass: For Una Henry on Saturday 25th April at 6pm.
Anniversary Mass: For Tilly Higgins on Sunday 26th April at 11.30am.
Anniversary Mass: For Patsy Marti on Sunday 3rd May at 11.30am.

Saturday Vigil Mass 6pm - St. Mary's Church in May.
Eucharistic Adoration: - Adoration on Monday after 10am Mass until 2.30pm.
…….

Sick Visitation: Fr. Crowley will attend the sick in his care on Thursday in the morning in Glenullin and the afternoon in Ballerin/Garvagh.

Errigal Youth Group - "Mary and Me" Our next youth group gathering will take place on Sunday 10th May, and this month we will be reflecting on Mary, honouring her during the month traditionally dedicated to her. Together we will explore who Mary is, her role in our faith, and what her example means for our lives today. Details: Date: Sunday 10th May Time: 7:00pm - 8:30pm. Venue: Minor Hall, Glenullin GAC, Curraghmore Road. For: Young people aged 11–14. All young people are very welcome — whether they attend regularly or are joining us for the first time. We look forward to an evening of faith, friendship, and fun. "Do whatever He tells you." - John 2:5

Errigal Parish Pastoral Survey - Summary of Findings: Thank you to all who participated in our recent "Future of Parish Life" survey. We were greatly encouraged by the strong response, and your feedback has provided valuable guidance for the Errigal Pastoral Group as we plan for the months ahead. A summary page with the full breakdown of results is available for parishioners to view. From the survey, there was particular support for the

development of: A. Bereavement Ministry, and B. Parish Pilgrimage Group (including interest in Lough Derg).
In light of this, the Pastoral Group will now begin working on these two priority areas. Further details will be shared as plans progress.
While the group can only take forward a limited number of initiatives at one time, we were heartened to see strong interest in several other suggested groups. If any parishioners feel called to help establish or lead one of these additional groups, you are warmly invited to contact Fr Crowley or any member of the Pastoral Group.
Thank you once again for your thoughtful contributions and for your continued support of parish life in Errigal.

St. Mary's - May Altar Society: Josephine McKeowm. Philip McKeown, Naula Mullan, and Paul Mullan. **St. Mary's - May Collectors - (Saturday)** Barney O'Kane.
(Sunday) Seamus O'Kane & Charlie O'Kane.
St. Joseph's - May Altar Society: Tracy Mullan, Katherine Ann McGoldrick, and Katherine Anderson.
St. Joseph's - May Counters: Danny & Anne McCloskey, and Grainne McNeill.
St. Joseph's May Collectors: (Sunday) Sean Quinn, John Heaney, and John Padraig O'Kane.

The Columban Young Adults: Is a new group for those aged 18 - 30 in the diocese, seeking a community of like-minded young adults who have Christ at the centre of their lives. The first event will be a talk on Thursday 30th April, at 7:30pm in our Lady of Lourdes Church, Steelstown, Derry, delivered by the Servant Sisters of Home of the Mother. It will be on the question, ' Why be a Young Catholic in 2026', in which they will also reflect on the life of Sr. Clare Crockett. The talk will be followed by Solemn Benediction and light refreshments.

Silver Episcopal Ordination of Bishop McKeown: Con-celebrated Mass in St Eugene's Cathedral on Sunday 26th April at 3pm. Followed by refreshments served in St Mary's College, Northland Road, Derry (BT48 0AN). The Bishop's family and a number of personal invitees will be present for the celebration.

Trócaire Boxes: Please return to the churches in the parish as soon as possible to enable the final count to take place. **If you are a taxpayer, please sign the Gift Aid card contained in the Trócaire box and return with your donation.**

Derry Diocesan Pilgrimage to Knock Shrine: Will take place on Saturday 6th June. In conjunction with the All-Ireland Rosary Rally, we will join those gathered to celebrate at our National Eucharistic and Marian Shrine. For those for whom it is convenient, buses will leave St. Eugene's Cathedral, Derry, at 8am: cost £50, which includes dinner in Knock House Hotel following the conclusion of the Mass in the Basilica. For further information, please contact Karen in the parish office at St Eugene's on 7126 2894 or by email at cathedral@derrydiocese.org. Full schedule to follow.

Lough Derg - Three Day Pilgrimage: Friday 29th May - Saturday 15th August (Season) Adm - €85 Booking advised. Concessions available for students, seniors and groups. Tel (00353) 719861518. info@loughderg.org **One Day Retreat** - A Day of Guided Prayer and Reflection. May - 3rd/4th/ 9th/12th/17th/23rd/25th

Parish Envelopes: The new cycle of envelopes has now been distributed. Those who contribute to the parish by standing order or currently receive envelopes - Thank you for your generosity towards the parish! If you wish further information regarding setting up a Standing Order or the use of envelopes. Please contact using the parish email address (errigalparish@gmail.com), or telephone 29558251. (voicemail available)

Baptism Dates: The next Baptism dates are Saturday 9th May in St. Mary's Church at 5pm and St. Joseph's Church on Sunday 17th May at 12.30pm. The Baptismal Programme for parents/guardians will take place in the Parochial House on Wednesday 6th May at 7pm. Please register to attend the Baptismal Programme by Friday 1st May using the parish email address, this will indicate to the team the numbers who will attend the Baptismal Programme.

Monday Adoration Adorers: We request if you are available on Monday from after the morning Mass to participate in the rota for Adoration of the Blessed Sacrament which takes place until 2.30pm. If interested, please leave your name/contact number in the sacristy and we will follow up.

Parish Collections - Thank you. 182 boxes of envelopes in circulation.
Returns - (Pink/Yellow - 131 White - 85)
St. Mary's - Parish: £805 Renovation: £170
St. Joseph's - Parish: £520 Renovation: £395
Trócaire Collection (1st Count) £6,246.00 (including)
St. Patrick's & St. Josephs School - £1,725.00
St. Columba's School - £303.00.

Ballerin GAA Lotto: There was no winner of the lotto jackpot the numbers are 8, 11, 24, 27. Next week's Jackpot is £4,300. £50 Winner - Sinead Cassidy.
Glenullin GAA Lotto: There was no winner of the lotto jackpot the numbers are 5, 8, 23, 28. Jackpot £10.000. £25 winners - Noleen McIlvar, Seamus O'Kane (Tam), Phillipa Mc Kinless, and Eoin McGuigan.

<u>Readers & Eucharistic Ministers</u>
St. Mary's Church - Church Readers 2nd/3rd May
Saturday Vigil - Arranged.
Sunday Morning - Paul Mullan.
If anyone is interested in becoming a Reader in St. Mary's Church, please gave your name to Fr. Crowley training will be provided.
Eucharistic Ministers - 2nd/3rd May
Saturday Vigil - Louise Mullan & Corey Bradley.
Sunday Morning - Amanda Mooney & Lee Ann McKay.
.....
<u>Readers & Eucharistic Ministers</u>
St. Joseph's Church - Church Readers - 2nd/3rd May
Saturday Vigil -
Sunday Morning - Lawrence O'Kane.
If anyone is interested in becoming a Reader in St. Joseph's Church, please gave your name to Fr. Crowley or Mairead Mc Nicholl (Lector Co-Ordinator), training will be provided.
Eucharistic Ministers - 2nd/3rd May
Saturday Vigil -

Sunday Morning - Margaret Rose Hasson & Kieran Quigg.

Feasts during the Week: Monday - St. Asicus: He was St. Patrick's expert craftsman in metal work and accompanies him on his journeys. He was left in charge of the church in Elphin which Patrick is said to have founded. **Tuesday - St. Peter Chanel (1803 - 41):** Is honoured as the first martyr of the Church in Oceania. **St. Louis Marie de Montfort (1673 - 1716):** Was a priest whose calling was to preach missions and to care for the sick and the poor. His writings concern Mary's role in the mystery of salvation. He strongly promoted the praying of the rosary. **Saturday - Wednesday - St. Catherine of Siena (1347 -1380):** She was a humble and dauntless Dominican tertiary, who brought peace to her native Siena, to Italy, and to fourteenth century Europe. She spent all her energies on the Church, being able to achieve the pope's return from Avignon to Rome. She is remembered also as a mystic and reformer of religious life. Proclaimed doctor of the Church in 1970 and patron of Europe in 2000. **Thursday - St Pius V (1504 -1572):** Dominican elected pope in 1565, he implemented the reforms of the Council of Trent, including the Breviary, Missal and Catechism. He is noted for his defence of Christendom against the Ottoman empire. **Friday - St. Joseph the Worker:** This feast, instituted by Pope Pius XII in 1955, proposes the example and intercession of St. Joseph as worker and patron of workers. On this date many countries celebrate the dignity of human labour. **Saturday - St. Athanasius:** Was born at Alexandria around 295, he fought ceaselessly against the Arian heresy, defending the true and equal divinity of Christ. As a result, he had to endure much tribulation, and he was several times sent into exile.

Diocesan Vocations: For further information, please contact the Diocesan Vocations Director, Fr Pat O'Hagan, at pgoh2111@gmail.com

Anniversaries: It is advisable where possible to book well in advance in the case of anniversaries. These are arranged with a sacristan as the anniversary book is kept in the sacristy. Also, please indicate in the Anniversary book that the Mass is booked for the stated intention - we would appreciate an acknowledgment of the booking by email if possible. **In the case of a booked Anniversary Mass please inquire of the sacristan before the Mass begins that the Mass is offered for the intention you request.** Names to be added to the weekend anniversary list need to be added to the anniversary book by informing the sacristan - this can be done in advance of the date requested.

Parish Readers/Eucharistic Ministers: If you are unable to attend the schedule allocated to you, it would be much appreciated if you can get a replacement to step in for you. (It may be possible to exchange a rotation with another group member - there is also the opportunity to seek cover via the Whatsapp messaging facility if available to your group). I also ask Readers please to conclude the readings with - **'The Word of the Lord'** as directed in the Missalette, and not 'This is the Word of the Lord' as stated in the Lectionary. We have previously discussed this at our reader meetings.

Derry Diocesan Youth Pilgrimage to Fatima: We are inviting young people aged 16+ to join us on pilgrimage to Fatima for five nights from 3rd to 8th August. This will be a unique experience for young people and an opportunity to engage with their peers from around the world in a faith context. Cost is £820 and there will be a budget plan to help with this. Names and deposit of £100 are required as soon as possible to secure a place. For more information or to book in please contact bethany.doherty@derrydiocese.org tel - 71264087

Accord Facilitators Needed: Accord is inviting volunteers to train as facilitators for its **Marriage Preparation Programmes**, supporting couples preparing for the Sacrament of Marriage. Facilitators work as part of a small local team and help lead up to four programmes each year. Free professional training is provided. To find out more or apply: Tel: 01 505 3112 Email: marriagepreparation@accord.ie
Closing date for applications: 29th May. Please consider sharing your experience of marriage to support couples preparing for this important sacrament.

'Shepherding Talent' Online Programme - *Aspire to Serve, Inspire to Lead:* In partnership with St Mary's University Twickenham, the Derry Diocesan Catechetical Centre is offering this programme. *'Shepherding Talent'* is a pioneering programme from the university, in which teaching professionals with leadership potential are challenged to explore their vocation to lead. Aimed at all teaching professionals in Catholic schools, this programme is delivered in the context of Catholic School education. It will be delivered over five weeks, with each session taking two hours. The total cost is £250. The first session takes place on Wednesday 29th April from 4.30pm - 6.30pm. For further information and registration please email: tferry@derrydiocese.org.

Derry Diocesan Pilgrimage to Lourdes 2026: Monday 29th June to Friday 3rd July: Due to the great demand for places, we have secured 50 extra seats ex-Dublin direct to Lourdes and return, with complimentary bus to the Airport. The fare is £895 pps full board. If you wish to book please contact the pilgrimage office at 164 Bishop St. Derry, Tel 02871 260293, email: derrypilgrim@outlook.com as soon as possible.

Look out Leaflets...Are now available for children at the back of both churches in the parish focusing on the liturgy of the word each week. Enjoy!
Children's Liturgy plans to run again at St. Joseph's Glenullin on the Sunday mornings of Lent. New volunteers are required to assist. This is an excellent opportunity to help our children and young JPII people be more involved! If interested in helping out, during the preparation seasons of Advent and Lent, please contact Clare Mullan 07812993538 so vetting can be processed and a rota organised.

Teach us to Pray Booklet - It can be downloaded at:
https://www.derrydiocese.org/news/teach-us-to-pray.

Fatima Trip - June 2026: Fully escorted group pilgrimage to Fatima, accompanied by Spiritual Director. 26th June - 3rd July 2026. Direct daytime flights, Belfast to Porto. Staying in 4* Hotel. Full board. Services of JWT pilgrimage guide. Daily Mass and Spiritual activities. Cost £895pps. Early booking offer - £100 off if paid in full by 3rd November 2025. Further details, please contact Christina Lagan: 07803192621.

Why Sunday Matters! The Irish Catholic Bishops' Conference have published a pastoral message titled '*Why Sunday Matters'* - an invitation to reflect on Sunday Mass. To access this resource and watch a four-part video series titles Sunday Mass - 'Digging Deeper', visit at CatholicBishops.ie

TheWay.ie: Is a new digital platform set up by the Irish Bishops Conference dedicated to sharing the 'Good News' and the witness of the Catholic Church in Ireland. It is intended to

help people discover the faith, live the faith and pass on the faith. It is for both seekers and followers. Follow us on Facebook, Instagram, X and YouTube.

Foyle Hospice 'Make a will Month': During the month of March local solicitors very kindly agree to waive their usual Will-writing fee in return for a suggested £100 donation to Foyle Hospice. A list of participating solicitors can be found at foylehospice.com/make-a-will/ or by calling Kathleen at the Foyle Hospice on 71359888. The purpose of 'Make a Will Month' is to encourage people to write their Wills, whilst also raising much-needed funds for Foyle Hospice. Money raised will ensure Foyle Hospice can continue to deliver high quality specialist palliative care and end of life care to those in our community with life-limiting illness.

St. Joseph's Church - A YouTube camera link is now available for services from St. Joseph's Church, Glenullin. The link can be accessed - **https://youtube.com**@parishoferrigalderry.

The Net: As always, it features a wide variety of news, interesting and inspiring interviews, articles, and photos from parishes across the diocese. You can read the Diocesan newspaper on-line at: www.derrydiocese.org/news/categories/the-net. or a paper copy is available at the back of the church. Donations welcome.

Prayer for Peace in the Middle East: God of mercy and compassion of grace and reconciliation, pour your presence upon all your children in the Middle East: Jews, Muslims, Christians, Palestinians, and Israelis. Let hatred be turned into love, fear to trust, despair to hope, oppression to freedom, occupation to liberation. That violent encounters may be replaced by loving embraces, and peace and justice maybe experienced by all. Amen.

St. Joseph's Church: We present a dual gauge to initiative funds in our parish for the on-going costs associated with the renovation of St. Joseph's Church. The gauge on the left indicates the funds we require to complete the refurbishment. The gauge on the right reflects the loans we have received from other parishes. (Gauge also available on website and Facebook page). **Thanks - Donations to date** - Current figure £234,800.00.

Providing compassionate care at the end of life - To address the sensitive issue of compassionate care at the end of life, and in response to the need to inform the faithful of Catholic teaching on this important life issue that affects so many families, the Bishops of Ireland have published the pastoral letter: Freedom to Live Fully, Until Death Comes. You are invited to read this letter and view the accompanying video Through the Valley, which offers personal testimonies by carers and people with terminal illness. The key message of both letter and video asserts that every person possesses inherent, infinite dignity that remains intact regardless of their circumstances. In this context, bishops strongly oppose the Oireachtas Committee's proposal to Government to legislate for assisted suicide and call on support for healthcare workers who uphold the sanctity of life. To read Freedom to Live Fully, Until Death Comes and to watch Through the Valley, visit the following link: https://www.catholicbishops.ie/2024/06/24/bishops-statement-on-end-of-life-care freedom-to-live-fully-until-death-comes/

The Catholic Communications Office of the Irish Bishops Conference: Produces a five-story weekly ezine Sharing Good News that reports on stories associated with the Bishops'

Conference, activities in parishes and dioceses, and that celebrates Church life generally. If you do not currently subscribe to receiving it and you wish to subscribe to receive Sharing Good News, please register your email address on https://catholicnews.ie/newsletter/

Errigal Hall Volunteers: For this hospitality to continue in the community, we need new volunteers to come forward and help in this voluntary service to the parish. If you are interested, please contact Melinda Robinson. If enough volunteers come forward a rota can be put in place via a WhatsApp group, so that the same people are not required at each function.

Errigal Hall: Parishioners who borrow items from the hall need to sign for their removal from the hall and when they are returned. The signing book is in the kitchen of the hall.

St. Joseph's Church: Choir Practice will take place each Tuesday at 7pm in the church. New members from Primary 4 up are very welcome. Any queries contact Roisin McIlvar 07841407154.
St. Mary's Church Choir: If you are interested in joining the choir, you are welcome to attend the practice in the church on a Wednesday evening at 7pm. Or contact any choir member.

Derry Diocesan Society (DDS): In each of the parishes of the diocese Mass is offered alternating in each parish (list at the back of each church) for deceased and living members who are registered in the society. The deceased members registered are remembered in the anniversary list for three consecutive weekends each quarter (three months). Registration is £20 and can be given to a sacristan or Fr. Crowley - please ensure name and address of the person to be enrolled is included and whether it is for a living or deceased member.

Maternity Blessing: Expectant mothers are welcome to receive a blessing in any of the sacristies following Mass - and a prayer card for their pregnancy.

Stamps: For the missions can be left at the back of each church.

Synodal Pathway: Find attached the final versions of the National Synthesis for the Church in Ireland, which is the fruit of the recent process of listening and consultation; it is based on the syntheses produced by the 26 dioceses in Ireland, as well as those submitted by religious congregations and other interested groups. Also attach appendix document from survivors of abuse and the Irish Bishops' Conference Cover Letter, which have all been forwarded to the General Secretariat of the Synod of Bishops. Press Release also attached. We are requested to bring the Report to the attention of your parishioners and to share it on your social media outlets. It will be a useful tool as parishes move forward on the synodal journey in the

autumn. **The Report is now available on the website of the Synodal Pathway of the Church in Ireland website: www.synod.ie**

Parish Envelopes: Following previous discussion with the Parish Finance Committee we encourage consideration for those who use envelopes infrequently to consider the use of a standing order, (through this medium you have full control), of the donation at your disposal. **Further information is available from the parish website.**
If you advance the standing order, (it can be processed on-line with your bank), or alternatively bring the completed mandate to your bank. We request that when you are issuing your instruction to the bank, that you do so with your personal name, in doing so we can therefore identify from whom the standing order has been authorised. It is with your authorisation that the standing order is either processed weekly or monthly. Also, you can withdraw the mandate at your own discretion. We would appreciate an acknowledgement of this transaction (via the parish email) when it is activated, so that we can have a copy for the parish records. In the information forwarded we will require your address and telephone number.
Several parishioners recently have set up a standing order, however we do not know who these parishioners are because they have not provided an address. We ask please that you follow the instructions above and email the parish to inform us who has authorised the standing order.
We request now that the boxes are delivered, if you have not previously returned or updated a parish Census card, please complete the card in the back of the box and return in the collection envelope. Also, the Gift Aid card needs to be signed and returned if you are a taxpayer.
Those who avail of Standing Orders are also asked to complete a Census card and Gift Aid card. These can be collected in each sacristy and returned at your convenience.

Details of Parish Accounts for Standing Orders:
(Errigal Ballerin: Sort Code - 950346 - Account No. 40067059 is the No 1 a/c) Errigal Development: Sort Code - 950346 - (Account No. 90042358 is the Renovation a/c). (Errigal Glenullin: Sort Code - 950346 Account No. 90062596 is the No 1 a/c) (Errigal Parish: Sort Code 950689 - Account No. 90083712 is the Renovation a/c).
Parish Finance: If you wish to contribute to the parish by standing order - forms can be forwarded upon request by sending an email to - errigalparish@gmail.com or they are available on the parish website. At the end of each month, we shall include in the collection figures the amounts relating to the increase in standing orders, these figures are stated in brackets.
Parish Census: In the recent distribution of collection envelopes, we request that at your earliest convenience you might return the census card with your family details for

parish registration. Also, the Gift Aid card needs to be updated and signed so that the parish can claim Gift Aid if you are a taxpayer, this does not affect your personal details or taxation. If your tax circumstances change, please inform us, if you are no longer a taxpayer.
Census cards are available in each sacristy, once completed they can be returned in a sealed envelope via the collection box at the back of each church. If you have previously registered, you do not have to do so again, unless your household occupation has changed.

Church Cleaners: Cleaners are required to join the existing monthly groups who clean each church. The more that participate the less occasions that individuals will be required to cover. If interested, please leave your name/contact phone number in each sacristy or alternatively give details to a sacristan.

Mass Cards/Mass Bouquets: Are available for sale at the back of each church please put the money in the candle box.

ACCORD - Counselling: If you need to speak, to an experienced couples and relationships counsellor during this time of unprecedented stress and pressure on family life, please contact 95680151. This is a free helpline service available from 9am - 8pm. Monday to Friday. All calls charged at local rate.

ACCORD DERRY: Virtual Interactive Marriage Preparation Programme (limited to 15 couples per course). Booking now online at www.accordni.com

Radio Maria Ireland: https://www.radiomaria.ie/radio-maria-ireland/ is an Irish-run Catholic Talk-Radio Station with commercial-free broadcasting of Prayer, Catechesis, Music, Talks, Interviews and Testimonies.

Church Safeguarding: If you have any concerns with regard to Safeguarding children or adults in need of protection within the Church please contact: Mrs Marie O'Kane (Designated Liaison Person), Diocesan Pastoral Centre, 164 Bishop Street, Derry. Tel: 02871 - 362475/07596500793. Email: dlp@derrydiocese.org - or PSNI (Police Service of Northern Ireland) 101 or Social Services Tel: 02871-314090.
Parish Representatives - Tracey McGilligan and Clare Mullan.
Errigal Privacy Notice: The Diocese of Derry complies with GDPR regulations. A privacy notice is available on the Parish Website or alternatively it is available from the Parish Office. Live stream of Mass and Services in St. Mary's Church and a Utube streaming in St. Joseph's Church are available online. Parishioners should note that the first three rows of seats are visible in St. Mary's Church.